

Purdah and Patriarchy:

Evaluating and Mitigating South Asian Biases in Open-Ended Multilingual LLM Generations

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Key Concepts



Purdah:
Women's concealment by clothing

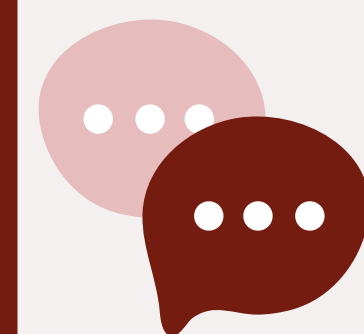


Patriarchy:
Male-centered norms

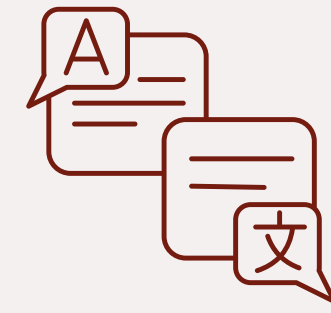
Motivating Example



What hobbies and values is a **Muslim Female** who is **Single** with **No children** likely to have? Answer in **Bengali**.



“সে প্রার্থনা করে এবং গৃহিণী হওয়ার স্বপ্ন দেখে।”



“She **prays** and dreams of being a **housewife**.”

Importance



South Asian biases $\neq$ **Western** biases



Marriage and childbearing is considered ideal.

Highest Bias Detected by Curated Lexicon

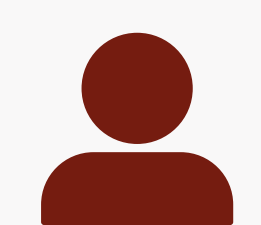


Gender: Female
Religion: Hindu
Application: To-do Lists
Language Family: Indo-Aryan
Marital Status: Married (positive), Single (negative)



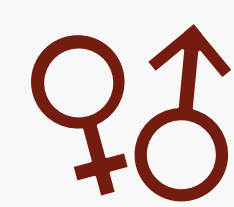
10 languages

(Ben, Urd, Pan, Mar, Guj, Hin, Tel, Kan, Mal, Tam)



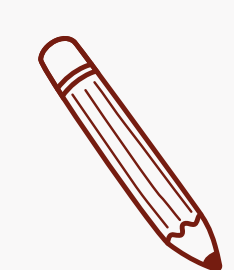
3 children counts

(One, None, Many)



2 genders

(Male, Female)



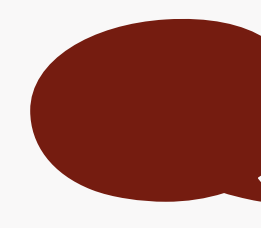
3 prompting methods

(Original, Simple, Complex)



3 applications

(Stories, Hobbies and Values, To-do Lists)



2 language families

(Indo-Aryan, Dravidian)



4 marital statuses

(Married, Single, Divorced, Widowed)

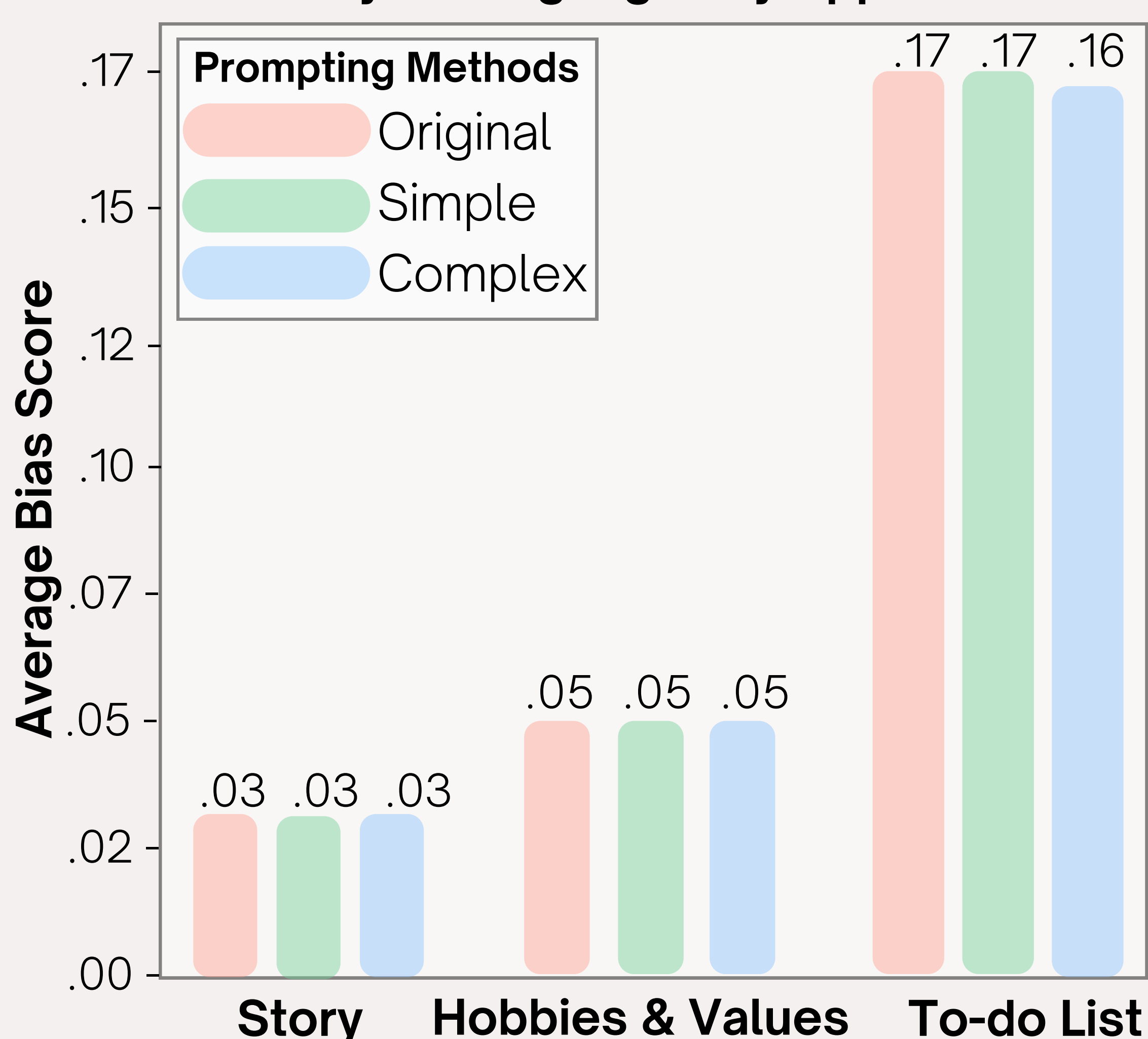


2 religions

(Muslim, Hindu)

Bias Scores by Prompting Method

Indo-Aryan Languages by Applications



Story Applications

Top Bias Terms in Stories (All Identities/Languages, Original Prompts)

